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report_item.sh — § . . reporting-directive engine

Field	Value
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Script	`constitution/scripts/reporting/report_item.sh`
Authority	`constitution/Constitution.md` §11.4.202

Overview

`report_item.sh` turns a plain-language REPORT — delivered by the §11.4.140 reporting directives `ISSUE` / `BUG` / `TASK`, or by any other caller — into a **real, fully-populated, fully-synced workable item**.

```
report text
   ├─(1) CREATE → the workable-items SQLite SSoT (§11.4.93 / §11.4.95)
   │              Type (§11.4.16) + Status=Queued (§11.4.15) + stable id
(§11.4.54)
   │              + comprehensive structured description (§11.4.148 /
§11.4.171)
   ├─(2) SYNC   → every derived document regenerated FROM the DB
   │              (Issues / Fixed / summaries + HTML/PDF/DOCX siblings)
   └─(3) PUSH   → every configured external tracker (§11.4.148 D5)
                  absent credentials / client ⇒ honest SKIP, NEVER a
faked push
```

A report that is discussed but never tracked is a §11.4 PASS-bluff at the requirements-intake layer (§11.4.197 — a started requirement never evaporates).

Prerequisites

- `python3` (+PyYAML) — reads the consumer config.
- The `workable-items` Go binary (committed in the constitution, or built, or pointed at via `$WORKABLE_ITEMS_BIN`).
- A **consumer-owned config** (the engine refuses to guess — §11.4.6):

```
mkdir -p .helix
cp constitution/scripts/reporting/reporting.example.yaml .helix/reporting.yaml
$EDITOR .helix/reporting.yaml    # db, id_prefix, sync_command, trackers
```

Search order: `$HELIX_REPORTING_CONFIG` → `.helix/reporting.yaml` → `config/reporting/reporting.yaml`.

Usage examples

```
# A defect (Type=Bug, fixed):
bash constitution/scripts/reporting/report_item.sh --kind bug \
  --report 'Audio drops to stereo on the AVR after a reboot; the receiver shows PCM 2.0.'

# An internal workstream item (Type=Task, fixed):
bash constitution/scripts/reporting/report_item.sh --kind task \
  --report 'Extend the flasher to take an explicit --serial (§11.4.200).'

# A generic report — the type MUST be classified into {Bug|Feature|Task}:
bash constitution/scripts/reporting/report_item.sh --kind issue --type Feature \
  --title 'Per-display font scale' --report 'The TV needs its own default font size.'

# Rich, structured intake (omitted sections ⇒ honest UNKNOWN:, never invented)
bash constitution/scripts/reporting/report_item.sh --kind bug \
  --title 'Subtitles render the control-menu label' \
  --report 'The 2nd display shows the chrome label instead of the dialogue cue.' \
  --scope 'presenter: PresenterAccessibilityService.kt' \
  --repro 'Play a RU title, open Audio&Subtitles, press back.' \
  --acceptance 'Only dialogue cues render; the denylist rejects chrome labels.' \
  --severity Critical --json

# Preview without writing anything:
bash constitution/scripts/reporting/report_item.sh --kind bug --report '...' --dry-run
```

Flag	Meaning
`--kind bug|task|issue`	required. `bug` ⇒Type=Bug, `task` ⇒Type=Task, `issue` ⇒needs `--type`
`--type Bug|Feature|Task`	required for `--kind issue` (§11.4.16 closed set)
`--autonomous`	for `--kind issue` with no `--type`: use the §11.4.16 lowest-stakes default `Task` **and record the defaulted classification** in the item
`--report` / `--report-file` / stdin	the report text (in that precedence)
`--title`	optional; derived from the report's first sentence when omitted
`--scope`, `--repro`, `--acceptance`	optional structured sections
`--severity`, `--reported-by`	optional; fall back to the config defaults
`--no-sync`, `--no-tracker`	skip step 2 / step 3
`--dry-run`, `--json`	preview / machine-readable result

Edge cases (all honest, none faked)

Situation	Behaviour
No config found	**Exit 2** with the template path. The engine never guesses your DB path (§11.4.6).
`--kind issue` without `--type`	**Refused** (exit 64). Classify it, ASK the operator (§11.4.66), or pass `--autonomous`.
Tracker credentials unset	Verdict `SKIP`, reason `credentials_absent: unset env: NAME …` — **variable names only, never values** (§11.4.10).
Tracker client not built	Verdict `SKIP`, reason `tracker_client_absent` (PENDING-OPERATOR-INPUT).
Tracker command fails	Verdict `FAIL` with its exit code — reported, never hidden. The item still exists.
Sync command fails	**Exit 5**. The item IS created (the DB is the SSoT); re-run the sync.
No `sync_command` configured	Honest `SKIPPED` with reason — never an invented command.

A tracker `PASS` is recorded **only** after a real push command exits 0.

Internal behaviour

1. **Config** → python3/PyYAML → shell-safe `KEY=value` pairs (values quoted).
2. **Binary** → `$WORKABLE_ITEMS_BIN` → config → committed constitution binary → `go build`.
3. **Description** → the §11.4.148 D2 template. Sections the report does not state are written as explicit `UNKNOWN:` gaps — never invented (§11.4.6).
4. **Create** → `workable-items add <Type> <Severity> …`; the assigned id is parsed from the binary's own output.
5. **Sync** → the consumer's `sync_command` (`{db}` substituted), run from the project root.

6. **Trackers** → for each: presence-check `required_env` (never value-read), render `{db}` / `{id}`, run, capture.
7. **Evidence** → `<evidence_dir>/<id>_<ts>/result.json` + `create.log` + `sync.log` + `tracker_<name>.log` (§11.4.5 / §11.4.69).

Decoupling (§ . . / § . .)

The engine carries **zero project literals** and is inherited **by reference** (never copied). Every project-specific value is consumer-owned DATA. The `CM-REPORTING-DIRECTIVES` gate enforces this (a hardcoded track path or id prefix in the engine → gate FAILs).

Related

Path	Purpose
`constitution/actions/registry.yaml`	the `ISSUE` / `BUG` / `TASK` rows + the grammar
`constitution/scripts/action_prefix_lib.sh`	the §11.4.140 parser (all six forms)
`constitution/scripts/reporting/reporting.example.yaml`	the consumer config template
`constitution/scripts/gates/cm_reporting_directives.sh`	the pre-build gate (+ its §1.1 mutation test)
`tests/reporting/test_report_item_e2e.sh`	the real-DB end-to-end + self-validation suite
`constitution/scripts/workable-items/`	the DB SSoT binary (§11.4.93)

Last verified: 2026-07-15 — end-to-end against a real SQLite DB: item created with the correct Type/Status/id, docs regenerated from the DB, both trackers SKIPped with honest reasons (38/38 PASS); gate 21/21 PASS with all 6 paired mutations caught.